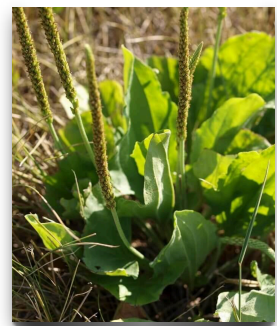


Plantain

Plantago Ovata

JW Farms 7



- narrowleaf plantain (*Plantago lanceolata*)
- blackseed plantain (*Plantago rugelii*)
- blond plantain (*Plantago ovata*)
- bracted plantain (*Plantago aristata*)
- Chinese plantain (*Plantago asiatica*)
- buck's-horn plantain (*Plantago coronopus*)
- woolly plantain (*Plantago patagonica*)

Plantain plants all have edible leaves and seeds that have been used medicinally for thousands of years. Plantain is a FRUIT despite looking like a weed. It is packed with tannins, aucubin and mucilage. It is loaded with vitamins and minerals. It is high in fiber, contains seven flavonoids, and vitamins A, B1, B2, B3, C, and K. Plantain is also an excellent dietary source of calcium, iron, chromium, phosphorus, magnesium, manganese, potassium, zinc, and selenium.



Broadleaf Plantain reproduces almost entirely by seed. However, plants sometimes regenerate from a broken leaf or cut root crown. A healthy plant produces greater than 15,000 seeds per year. Sticky when wet, the little seeds adhere to wildlife or are transported by birds and the wind.

Plantain seeds retain viability in the soil for more than 65 years. Hence, it will be around no doubt for a long time.

If you want to make plantain oil, instead of buying it, you will need a carrier oil (such as almond, apricot, or olive oil). Grape seed oil is another choice, but it goes rancid quickly and chemicals are used to extract it. You will need either dried or fresh plantain. If using dried, you need half as much as you would fresh, as the dried herb is concentrated. You will also need a jar with a tight fitting lid. A half pint canning jar will work well for this.

If using fresh plantain, you need to wilt the plant for at least 24 hours to allow moisture to escape. If you don't do this, your oil could get a fungus.

Wound Healing
 Digestion
 Bug Bites
 Stings
 Skin
 Eczema
 Rashes
 Itching
 Congestion
 Allergies
 Decongestant
 Expectorant
 Bronchitis
 Asthma
 Sore Throat
 Phlegm
 Cough
 Colds
 Constipation
 Mucilage
 Sunburn
 Acne
 Reduces Scarring
 Hair
 IBS
 Cholesterol Leveler
 Liver
 Jaundice
 Blood Purifier
 Diuretic
 Astringent
 Sedative



The Anti' s:

AntiInflammatory
 Antimicrobial
 Antifungal
 Antibacterial
 Antiviral
 Antiseptic

JW Farms 7

The leaves, flowers seed pods and seeds. The Seeds are packed full of nutrients and can be eaten raw or cooked.

The Plantain WEED is a better alternative than other choices given they have more beta-carotene than carrots and more iron and calcium than spinach.

You can make Tea with the dried leaves.

You may recognize the nutrient Psyllium. Did you know that Psyllium is the seeds of a plantain plant?

The seeds(Psyllium) are a laxative. It is very high in Fiber. You can make a tea with them or infuse them into alcohol or oil for use later. This has been used all over the world for thousands of years.

The seeds may be dried and ground to make a flour to add to dishes or breads while cooking.



Caution

*Fresh plantain weed can be eaten safely with minimal risk of adverse effects. Yet, supplements may cause mild side effects, including digestive issues.

***Nutrient absorption:** Taking psyllium along with your meals for a long time can adversely affect the absorption of nutrients.

*The constituents of plantain may interfere with the functioning of such medications.

The leaves of plantain are edible and are cooked as greens or used raw in salads. Older leaves have a stronger flavor and are a bit stringy. These are good to be used in herbal teas, to dehydrate for use later and are particularly suitable for survival situations where the tough fibers may be converted to rope or fishing line.